

Day 71 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in TN History/Culture/Heritage (3): Keeladi Open-Air Museum & New Regional Museums

READING MATERIAL

Covers the newly inaugurated Keeladi Open-Air Museum and related new regional museum projects in Tamil Nadu — extending the project's existing Keezhadi excavation coverage with the latest concrete development.

Q: When was the Keeladi Open-Air Museum inaugurated, by whom, and how?

A: 14 February 2026, by Chief Minister M.K. Stalin, via video conferencing.

Q: What is distinctive about this museum compared to a typical archaeology museum?

A: It is believed to be the first facility of its kind in India where archaeological remains are displayed IN their original context/surroundings — i.e., built directly at the excavation site, rather than artifacts being moved to a separate museum building elsewhere.

Q: What is the Keeladi Open-Air Museum's area and cost?

A: Developed across 4.5 acres at a cost of ₹24 crore, with two exhibition halls (combined built-up area of 65,380 sq. ft.), positioned about 80 metres apart.

Q: What structural remains (over 2,000 years old) are preserved and displayed at the site?

A: Brick walls, ring wells, terracotta pipelines, and drainage systems — from the 2nd, 5th, and 6th excavation phases at Keeladi.

Q: What other museum was announced (at the same event) for the Chola dynasty, and where?

A: A dedicated Chola Museum at Tamil University's Thanjavur campus, with an estimated budget of ₹56.14 crore.

Q: What other two regional museums had their foundation stones laid at the same event?

A: The Noyyal Museum (Erode district) and the Navai Museum (Ramanathapuram district).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Keeladi Open-Air Museum was inaugurated on:

A. 14 January 2026

B. 14 February 2026 ✓

C. 14 March 2026

D. 14 April 2026

Explanation: 14 February 2026. [medium, web-research]

2. What makes the Keeladi Open-Air Museum distinctive among Indian archaeology museums?

A. It is the largest museum in India

B. It displays remains in their original excavation context/site ✓

C. It is fully underground

D. It only displays digital/virtual exhibits

Explanation: Displays remains in their original excavation context/site — first such facility in India. [medium, web-research]

3. The Keeladi Open-Air Museum was developed across how many acres, at what cost?

A. 2.5 acres, ₹12 crore

B. 4.5 acres, ₹24 crore ✓

C. 6 acres, ₹35 crore

D. 10 acres, ₹50 crore

Explanation: 4.5 acres, ₹24 crore. [hard, web-research]

4. The structural remains displayed at Keeladi (brick walls, ring wells, terracotta pipelines, drainage systems) are from excavation phases:

A. 1st, 2nd, and 3rd

B. 2nd, 5th, and 6th ✓

C. 3rd, 4th, and 5th

D. 1st and 2nd only

Explanation: 2nd, 5th, and 6th excavation phases. [hard, web-research]

5. A new Chola Museum (₹56.14 crore) was announced to be built at:

A. Madurai Kamaraj University

B. Tamil University, Thanjavur ✓

C. Anna University, Chennai

D. Bharathidasan University, Trichy

Explanation: Tamil University, Thanjavur. [medium, web-research]

6. Which two regional museums had their foundation stones laid at the same event as the Keeladi museum's inauguration?

A. Noyyal Museum (Erode) and Navai Museum (Ramanathapuram) ✓

B. Cauvery Museum (Trichy) and Vaigai Museum (Madurai)

C. Kanyakumari Museum and Nilgiris Museum

D. Pondicherry Museum and Karaikal Museum

Explanation: Noyyal Museum (Erode) and Navai Museum (Ramanathapuram). [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Compound Interest

READING MATERIAL

Compound Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests the standard CI formula, a useful SI-vs-CI shortcut, AND disguises CI as 'successive percentage change' word problems (depreciation, year-over-year growth) — recognize all three shapes.

Q: Formula: What is the Compound Interest formula, and the shortcut for the DIFFERENCE between SI and CI over 2 years?

A: Amount = $P(1+R/100)^T$, so CI = Amount – P. For exactly 2 years, there's a shortcut: $CI - SI = P \times (R/100)^2$. This avoids computing CI and SI separately when you only need their difference.

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.5,000 at 8% per annum.

A: Using the shortcut: difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 5000 \times (0.08)^2 = 5000 \times 0.0064 = \text{Rs.}32$. (Full check: SI = $5000 \times 8 \times 2/100 = 800$. CI = $5000 \times (1.08^2 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.1664 = 832$. Difference = $832 - 800 = 32$ ✓.)

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the compound interest on Rs.5,000 at 12% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A: CI = $P \times ((1+R/100)^T - 1) = 5000 \times (1.12^2 - 1) = 5000 \times (1.2544 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.2544 = \text{Rs.}1,272$.

Q: Real exam (2025): A sum becomes Rs.13,380 after 3 years and Rs.20,070 after 6 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

A: The amount after 6 years equals the amount after 3 years multiplied by the SAME growth factor again (since compounding is multiplicative): $(1+R/100)^3 = 20070/13380 = 1.5$. The sum itself: $P = \text{Amount-after-3-years} \div (1+R/100)^3 = 13380 \div 1.5 = \text{Rs.}8,920$.

Q: Real exam (2024): A motorcycle's value 2 years ago was Rs.80,000. It depreciates 4% in the first year, then increases 4% in the second year. Find the present value.

A: Apply each year's change as its own multiplier, in sequence — this is compound interest with a changing/mixed rate: $80,000 \times 0.96$ (first year, -4%) $\times 1.04$ (second year, +4%) = $80,000 \times 0.9984 = \text{Rs.}79,872$. Note the result is slightly LESS than the original Rs.80,000 — a decrease followed by an equal-percentage increase never fully cancels out, since the increase applies to a smaller base.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.8,000 at 5% per annum.

- A. Rs.18
- B. Rs.20 ✓**
- C. Rs.22
- D. Rs.25

Explanation: Difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 8000 \times (0.05)^2 = 8000 \times 0.0025 = \text{Rs.}20$. [medium, authored]

2. Find the compound interest on Rs.10,000 at 10% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

- A. Rs.2,000
- B. Rs.2,100 ✓**
- C. Rs.2,200
- D. Rs.1,900

Explanation: CI = $10000 \times (1.10^2 - 1) = 10000 \times 0.21 = \text{Rs.}2,100$. [easy, authored]

3. A sum becomes Rs.16,000 after 2 years and Rs.19,360 after 4 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

- A. Rs.12,500
- B. Rs.13,000
- C. Rs.13,223 ✓**
- D. Rs.14,000

Explanation: $(1+R/100)^2 = 19360/16000 = 1.21$. $P = 16000/1.21 \approx \text{Rs.}13,223$. [hard, authored]

4. A machine valued at Rs.50,000 depreciates by 10% in the first year and a further 10% in the second year. Find its value after 2 years.

- A. Rs.40,000
- B. Rs.40,500 ✓**
- C. Rs.41,000
- D. Rs.39,500

Explanation: $50,000 \times 0.90 \times 0.90 = 50,000 \times 0.81 = \text{Rs.}40,500$. [medium, authored]

5. Find the compound interest on Rs.20,000 at 15% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A. Rs.6,000

B. Rs.6,450 ✓

C. Rs.6,200

D. Rs.6,500

Explanation: $CI = 20000 \times (1.15^2 - 1) = 20000 \times 0.3225 = \text{Rs.}6,450$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Reading Comprehension: Governance & Civic Passages (Set 1)

READING MATERIAL

TNPSC Reading Comprehension passages are short (3-5 lines) and civic/governance-themed. The standard question style asks which statements are 'best supported/inferred' from the passage — read carefully for statements that are NOT directly supported (a common trap is an option that sounds plausible but contradicts or isn't stated in the passage).

Q: Passage: "'Aadhaar', India's unique ID has expanded from welfare to various diverse services. It aimed to reduce fraud and boost financial inclusion. Concerns about privacy and exclusion persist. Court rulings balance security with rights." Which statements accurately reflect the passage's main ideas?

A: (b) Aadhaar's scope has grown beyond its initial purpose; (c) Aadhaar aimed to reduce fraud and improve financial inclusion; (d) Privacy and exclusion concerns are associated with Aadhaar. [NOT (a) — the passage explicitly says Aadhaar expanded BEYOND welfare, so 'only used for welfare distribution' contradicts it.]

Q: Passage: "With a sense of optimism slowly creeping in, the banking industry is hopeful that 2025 will bring better growth prospects... the RBI has initiated a number of measures that would go a long way in helping the banks to restructure themselves thereby improving the profile of non-performing banks." What is the biggest challenge for banks in India, per the passage?

A: Ever-increasing level of non-performing assets (NPAs) — the passage's entire focus is on RBI measures to help banks 'restructure' and improve their NPA profile, signalling NPAs as the core challenge (not corporate borrowers, financial-inclusion targets, or foreign-bank competition).

Q: Which question type 'illustrates a point or focuses attention on an idea or principle' (as a category of comprehension question)?

A: Rhetorical (as opposed to Funnel, Inference, or Divergent question types) — useful to know the standard names TNPSC uses for question categories, in case a question asks you to classify rather than answer.

Q: Passage: "Digital platforms enhance citizen access to government services. Online portals reduce bureaucratic delays. This implies increased transparency and efficiency. Streamlined processes foster public trust." Which statements can best be inferred?

A: (b) E-governance potentially increases transparency; (c) Streamlined processes can build public trust. [NOT (a) or (d) — both directly contradict the passage, which says digital platforms REDUCE delays and INCREASE access, not the opposite.]

Q: Passage: "Renewable energy reduces carbon emissions. Solar and wind power are increasingly viable. This transition combats climate change. Sustainable energy solutions are vital for future generations." Which statements best summarize the passage?

A: (b) Renewable energy reduces carbon emissions; (c) Solar and wind power are becoming increasingly viable; (d) Sustainable energy solutions are crucial for future generations. [NOT (a) — directly contradicts the passage's claim that renewable energy COMBATS climate change.]

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Passage: "'Aadhaar', India's unique ID has expanded from welfare to various diverse services. It aimed to reduce fraud and boost financial inclusion. Concerns about privacy and exclusion persist." Which statements accurately reflect the passage's main ideas? (a) Aadhaar is only used for welfare distribution (b) Aadhaar's scope has grown beyond its initial purpose (c) Aadhaar aimed to reduce fraud and improve financial inclusion (d) Privacy and exclusion concerns are associated with Aadhaar

- A. (a), (b), (c), (d)
- B. (b), (c), (d) ✓**
- C. (b) and (c)
- D. only (b)

Explanation: (b), (c), (d) — statement (a) contradicts the passage. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. Passage: banking industry optimism for 2025, RBI measures to help banks restructure and improve the profile of non-performing banks. What is the biggest challenge for banks in India?

- A. To handle corporate borrowers
- B. To pursue targets of financial inclusion
- C. Ever increasing level of non-performing assets ✓**
- D. Onslaught of foreign banks

Explanation: Ever increasing level of non-performing assets. [medium, question-bank-2025]

3. Which question type illustrates a point or focuses attention on an idea or principle?

- A. Rhetorical ✓**

- B. Funnel
- C. Inference
- D. Divergent

Explanation: Rhetorical. [hard, question-bank-2025]

4. Passage: "Digital platforms enhance citizen access to government services. Online portals reduce bureaucratic delays. This implies increased transparency and efficiency. Streamlined processes foster public trust." Which of the following can best be inferred? (a) E-governance increases bureaucratic delays (b) E-governance potentially increases transparency (c) Streamlined processes can build public trust (d) Digital platforms reduce citizen access to services

- A. (a) and (b)
- B. (b) and (d)
- C. (b) and (c) ✓**
- D. (a) and (d)

Explanation: (b) and (c) — (a) and (d) both contradict the passage. [medium, question-bank-2025]

5. Passage: "Renewable energy reduces carbon emissions. Solar and wind power are increasingly viable. This transition combats climate change. Sustainable energy solutions are vital for future generations." Which statements best summarize the passage? (a) Renewable energy has no impact on climate change (b) Renewable energy reduces carbon emissions (c) Solar and wind power are becoming increasingly viable (d) Sustainable energy solutions are crucial for future generations

- A. (b), (a), (c)
- B. (b), (d), (a)
- C. (a), (b), (c)
- D. (b), (c), (d) ✓**

Explanation: (b), (c), (d) — (a) contradicts the passage. [medium, question-bank-2025]